Azad was a talented and persuasive writer, and this repeatedly got him into trouble with the British Raj.



In the 1920s and 1930s, some Indian Muslims distrusted the Congress party and continued to support the British Empire. They were concerned that a Hindu-dominated Congress government would favour Hindus over others. The British stoked and exploited this fear as part of their policy to ‘divide and rule’. Azad’s courageous anti-colonial, pro-unity stance encouraged more Muslims to support the movement for freedom.

Azad the statesman

In 1920, Azad met Gandhi and became the first well-known Muslim in India to ally himself with the Congress. It was an important moment, for it represented the idea that Hindus and Muslims needed to work together to oppose the British. In the years that followed, Azad embraced non-violence and satyagraha, becoming one of the freedom movement’s most visible and respected figures. He helped organize the party’s election campaigns by raising funds and choosing candidates. He was also a prominent member of the Constituent Assembly and was outspoken about the importance of India being a secular nation.